

```
$ verydian boot --topic "instruction files"
```

```
loading context ... done
```

One instruction file, until a local file breaks it _

Claude Code now falls back to AGENTS.md. The resolution order has traps.

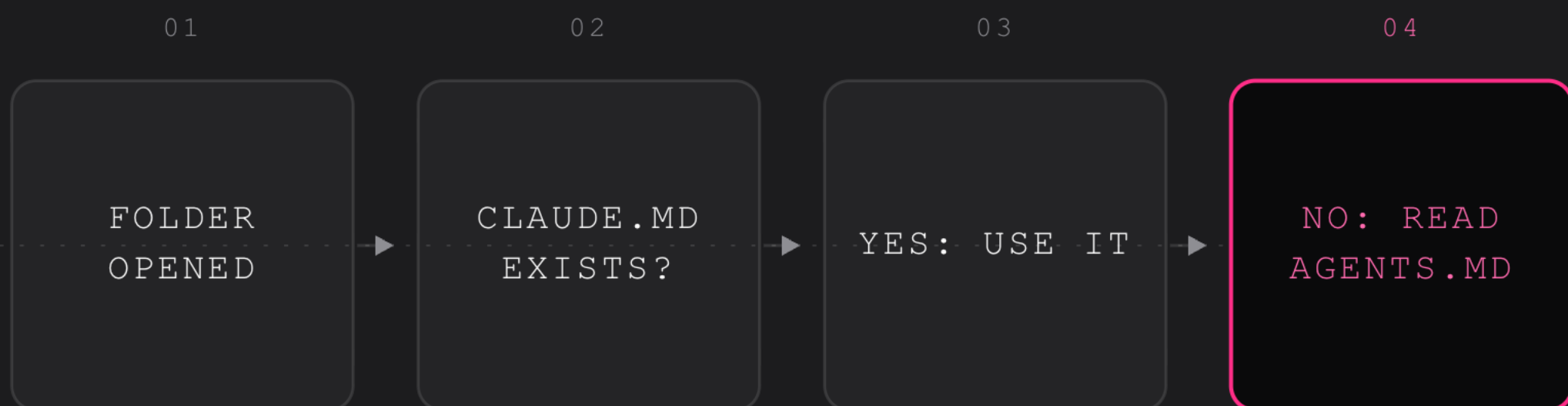
RUN SESSION —

```
arhem@verydian:~/resolution order$ step 2
```

How Claude Code picks the file

Since 2.1.277, CLAUDE.md is read first. Only a folder with no CLAUDE.md falls back to AGENTS.md.

STDOUT



arhem@verydian:~/the silent block\$ step 3

One local file switches it off

CLAUDE.local.md counts as a CLAUDE.md. Add one and AGENTS.md stops loading in that folder.

STDOUT

NO LOCAL FILE

— AGENTS.MD LOADS

— SHARED RULES APPLY

VS

CLAUDE.LOCAL.MD PRESENT

● AGENTS.MD BLOCKED

● SHARED RULES SKIPPED

```
arhem@verydian:~/gotchas$ step 4
```

What you can't see or use

Auto-loaded AGENTS.md is invisible in /memory and /context, and InstructionsLoaded hooks do not fire. Local and override variants are ignored.

STDOUT



NOT SHOWN IN /MEMORY

LIVE



NOT IN /CONTEXT LIST

PASS



INSTRUCTIONSLOADED HOOKS SILENT

PASS



AGENTS.LOCAL.MD IGNORED

PASS



AGENTS.OVERRIDE.MD IGNORED

PASS

```
arhem@verydian:~/provider limits$ step 5
```

Where it does not load

No support on Bedrock, Vertex or Foundry yet. It needs feature flags from Anthropic, so third-party providers or disabled telemetry fall back to CLAUDE.md.

STDOUT

01

BEDROCK

02

VERTEX

03

FOUNDRY

04

THIRD-PARTY
PROVIDERS

05

TELEMETRY
DISABLED

```
arhem@verydian:~/shared setup$ step 6
```

A setup that holds up





Test what Claude actually loaded.

Ask it to state a rule that exists only in your AGENTS.md.

RUN THE CHECK